DAY 4

Faith Without All the Answers



"Before Jesus, a father acknowledges that he believes and, at the same time, asks for help with his difficulty believing."

MARK 9:24

Questions arise even when you want to trust. Why does a generous person suffer so much? Why does an important prayer seem unanswered? How can you keep believing when the foundation of your certainty has been shaken? These questions can frighten you, especially if you learned that faith means never wavering. Alongside doubt comes the shame of feeling it.

In Mark 9, the father of a distressed boy comes to Jesus without first resolving that contradiction. He acknowledges the faith he has and asks for help with his unbelief. His words contain trust and difficulty together. Jesus does not demand a flawless declaration before receiving his request. The scene allows us to bring to God a faith that still needs help.

This does not make every doubt a virtue or remove the importance of seeking understanding. Some questions need study, conversation, and attention. Reading a passage in context, listening to someone mature, and admitting what we do not know can strengthen the journey. The difference is seeking understanding without believing we have the right to pray only after solving every question.

Perhaps the difficulty is not a question about God but a wound caused by someone who spoke in His name. Irresponsible promises, judgment, and inconsistent behavior can undermine trust. Acknowledging that history matters. You need not call something caring when it hurt you or pretend an abusive experience was good. Rebuilding faith can include boundaries and safe companionship.

Some questions remain open despite every effort. At such times, you can lean on what you understand without denying what remains unclear. You may not know how to explain a loss, yet still recognize the value of compassion. You may not understand the way ahead, yet choose honesty. Trust can find expression in small actions while your mind continues seeking answers.

You do not have to speak confidently about what you do not know. An honest prayer may be: 'Lord, I want to trust, but this situation frightens me.' That sentence does not diminish the relationship; it allows your reality into it. Acknowledging difficulty releases the energy spent maintaining appearances and lets you ask for help where you truly need it.

Today, welcome the faith that exists without demanding that it be complete. Make room for the question and for the good you have already encountered. Seek understanding patiently, but do not postpone every attempt to draw near. The father in that passage offers a possible beginning: bring trust and vulnerability to the Lord together. You can walk with questions, asking for help along the way.



TO KEEP IN YOUR HEART

You can bring your doubts to God without hiding the faith you still want to nurture.



TODAY'S PRAYER

Lord, I want to trust You, but some questions leave me uncertain. Receive my faith and help where it weakens. Give me humility to learn, courage to acknowledge my wounds, and discernment to seek nourishing companionship. Help me neither pretend certainty nor abandon the journey because I do not understand everything. Teach me to live with honesty, compassion, and hope while seeking answers. Support what is fragile in me and guide my steps patiently. Amen.